

It is God Which Worketh in You (4)

Divine Prerogatives

It is amazing to think that God is doing a work in us who have been redeemed by precious blood, to shape and mold us that we might be conformed to the image of His blessed Son. This work that God is doing in purifying and preparing us, in perfecting and preserving us, shows the immense value He places on every one of us and His unfailing care for us.

While all that God is doing is for our benefit and blessing, and is fulfilling His divine purposes for us, it is ultimately for His honour and glory and according to His divine will. Paul wrote of God's purpose in bringing us into the family of God, *"Having predestinated us unto the adoption of children by Jesus Christ to himself, according to the good pleasure of his will"* (Eph. 1:5).

God, through the riches of His grace has showered us with kindness in giving us wisdom and understanding and in revealing His divine purposes to us. Paul wrote in the book of Ephesians, *"Having made known unto us the mystery of his will, according to his good pleasure which he hath purposed in himself"* (Eph. 1:9).

We understand also from the apostle Paul, that God's grand purpose in making us inheritors of His kingdom and glory is according to His divine will. He wrote, *"In whom also we have obtained an inheritance, being predestinated according to the purpose of him who worketh all things after the counsel of his own will"* (Eph. 1:11).

God is also the divine architect in the foundation and formation of the church, fulfilling His purposes for a collective testimony to His name. Believers function in their respective roles and responsibilities according to His grand design, ultimately bringing glory to His name. The apostle Paul informs us in his first letter to Corinth, *"But now hath God set the members every one of them in the body, as it hath pleased him"* (1st Cor. 12:18).

James realized the purposes of God in choosing a people that would bring glory to His name. Quoting from the prophecy of Amos (9:11-12), he spoke to the council at Jerusalem, *"God at the first did visit the Gentiles, to take out of them a people for his name"* (Acts 15:14). Moses reminded the people of Israel, *"For thou art an holy people unto the Lord thy God, and the Lord hath chosen thee to be a peculiar people unto himself, above all the nations that are upon the earth"* (Deut. 14:2).

Peter used similar language to describe believers today, *"But ye are a chosen generation, a royal priesthood, an holy nation, a peculiar people; that ye should shew forth the praises of him who hath called you out of darkness into his marvellous light"* (1st Pet. 2:9). Interestingly, the word, *"peculiar"*, includes the thought of a purchased possession.

The apostle Paul reminds us in his first letter to the Corinthians, that we have been purchased by God and exhorts us to glorify Him, *"know ye not that your body is the temple of the Holy Ghost which is in you, which ye have of God, and ye are not your own? For ye are bought with a price: therefore glorify God in your body, and in your spirit, which are God's"* (1st Cor. 6:19:20).

We learn from Paul's letter to the Ephesians that the grand purpose of God's action in accepting us in His beloved Son, was for the praise of His glorious grace (Eph. 1:6). How we praise God for His glorious grace which was manifested in the giving of His blessed Son, who willingly gave Himself for us and shed His precious blood that we might be redeemed and reconciled to God.

God who works all things after the council of His own will, has purposed that through our testimony, as those who have trusted Christ, our lives we should be lived to the praise of His glory (Eph. 1:12).

The very moment that we trusted Christ as our Saviour; we were sealed with the Holy Spirit of God. He is referred to as the “*Spirit of promise*” and “*the earnest of our inheritance*”. The Holy Spirit, who dwells within every believer, is God’s guarantee of our eternal future. There is a day coming, when we shall experience the redemption of our bodies, when we shall be caught up to meet our Lord Jesus in the air and be changed into His likeness. Then we shall indeed be “*to the praise of His glory*” (Eph. 1: 13-14).

Paul wrote to the believers in Thessalonica concerning the coming of the Lord Jesus in glory. That is the time when He will come to set up His millennial kingdom and all of the redeemed shall return with Him. A wondering world will look on in amazement at what the grace of God has accomplished in the lives of those that have been redeemed by precious blood. Paul expressed, “*When he shall come to be glorified in his saints, and to be admired in all them that believe*” (2nd Thess. 1:10).

When we consider all that God has done for us, and all He is doing in us, we should until the moment that we are called from earth away, seek to glorify God in all we do. The apostle Paul exhorts us, “*whatsoever ye do, do all to the glory of God*” (1st Cor. 10:31).

*The Work of God within our soul,
We cannot understand;
We simply yield to His control,
Our times are in His hand.*

*A vessel sanctified and meet,
His purpose to fulfill;
Our service is in Him complete,
According to His will.*

*We’re not our own, bought with a price,
His name to glorify;
Who gave Himself a sacrifice,
That we might be brought nigh.*

*Brought from darkness into His light,
His virtues to show forth;
All that is done in Spirit’s might,
Declare His matchless worth.*

*We live to magnify His name,
The Father’s blessed Son,
Our living hope, our Lord, the same,
Til life on earth is done.*

*That He shall come, in yonder space,
Has every heart inspired;
Then shall the wonders of His grace
Be in His saints admired.*

Bernie Payne

